LEMON NIGHT

BATON ROUGE ALTERNATIVE

To be featured in the next zine, contact Davy Goldmsith at lemon.night.llc@gmail.com.

Lemon Night is a diy publishing and promotion company and a source for booking, distribution, and other creative services.

by: LEMON NIGHT

This zine contains work that is owned and copywrited by the original artist. Please do not copy or repoduce it in any way without their explicit consent.

What is a zine?

A zine (rhymes with "bean" and short for "magazine") is a short collection of images and text, usually from multiple artists or writers. Zines are typically self-published, relying on do-it-yourself means and philosophy and tend to focus on cultural phenomenons interesting to the publisher.

This zine is called Baton Rouge Alternative and it features work from local poets and artists, a few blurbs about recent releases, interviews with art or music related businesses, and a story about the history of the arts culture in Baton Rouge.

HELLO I'M BAD

I need a man for every mood
I like you and I like to defy your sweetness
With the pomp of a big fat secret
Can I give you this laurel wreath
Wove together by another man
I want to do evil things while I'm inside you
I only believe in this one pit
That is hardening in my stomach
And the face that I am sucking on
That it is not your face
Hello I'm bad

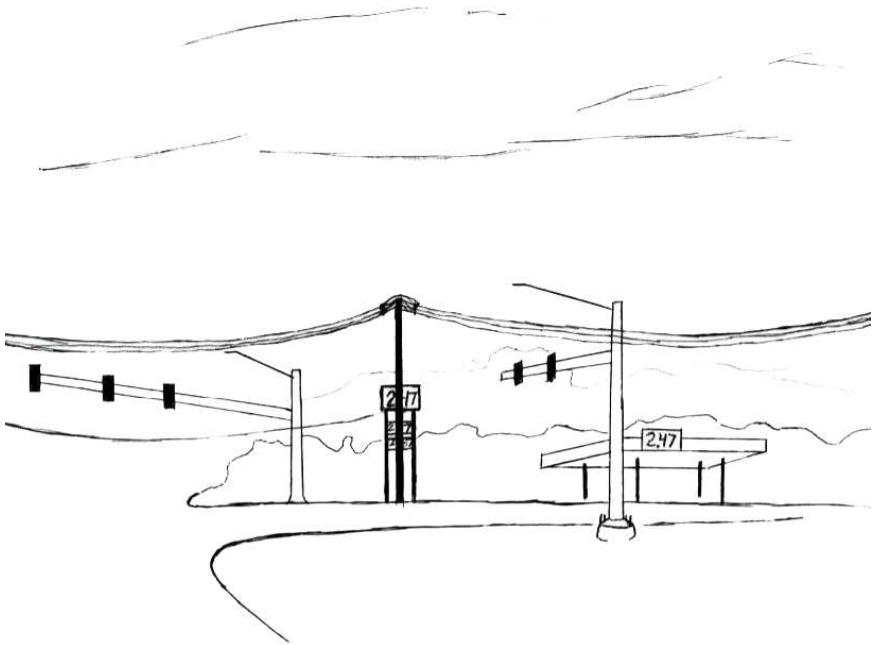
POMEGRANATES

Remember the day we discovered pomegranates
Our surprise hacking open the red fruit
Days of spitting out sharp seeds
Like baby teeth
It was so surprising
Next to the avocado the star fruit
The fruit that bears the name we've given to the sun
So much joy in each mouthful
Of wine-colored beads
We felt the earth loved us still

AMERICA

In America you get a car and some gas
And blast your way through
The last fresh air
To wherever

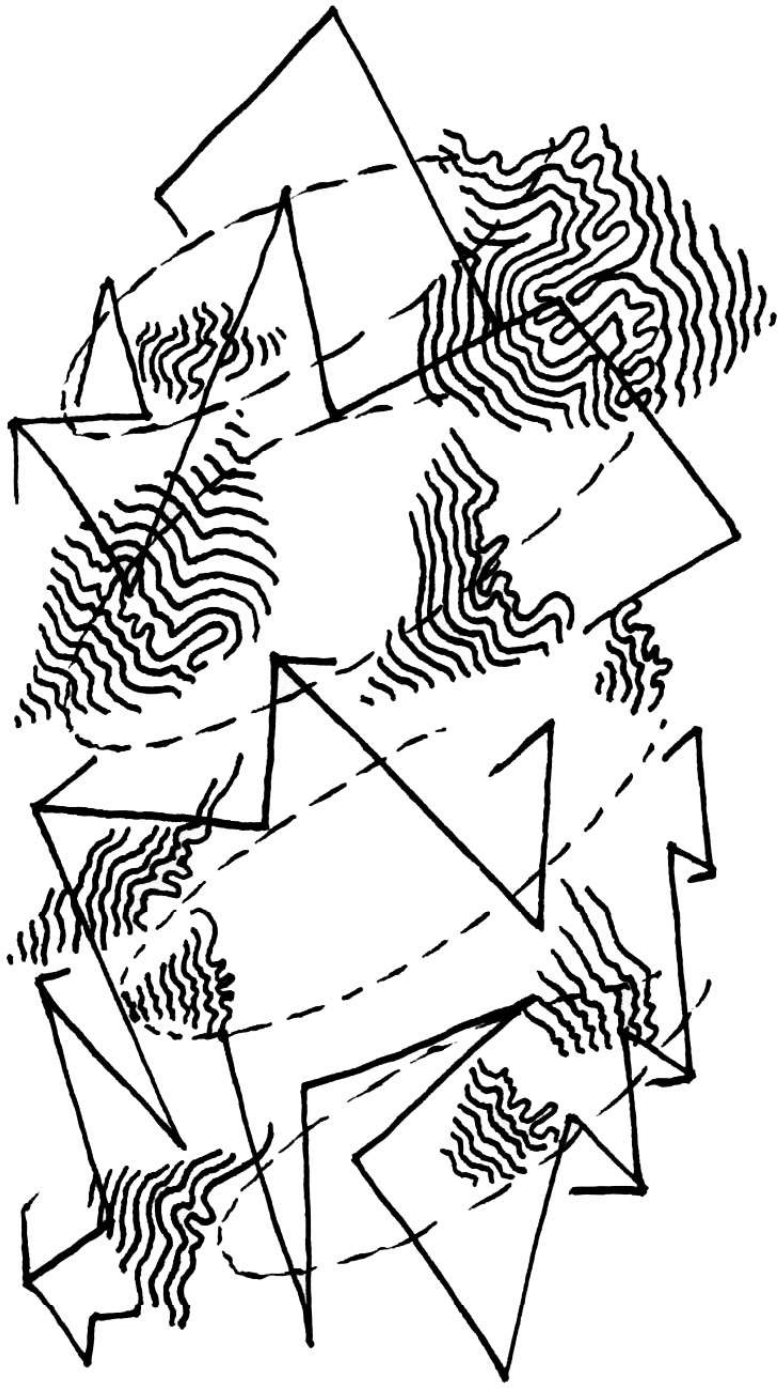
Laura Theobald
See page 7 for details on her upcoming release.



Davy Goldsmith

BATON ROUGE ALTERNATIVE

ZINE 1 - JULY 2018



Jeffrey Livingston

Earthship Records is a label/studio based in Louisiana producing digital music, music videos, cassettes, cd’s, and more.

earthshiprec.com

A SHORT HISTROY OF LOCAL MUSIC CONT.

DG: What are you most hopeful for in the future for Baton Rouge music?

GL: Just the fact that we're all coming together to put [on] these shows is one of these biggest things that that I'm very hopeful for. That makes me feel the scene is still alive and kicking especially [after] what happened recently with the whole venue shutting down[7]. That just shows an example of how far a lot people in Baton Rouge are willing to go help out. Especially every other band, you know? It's little things like that that make me believe its always going to be alive in Baton Rouge. There's always going to be a music scene but it's always the people who are going to keep it alive. It's always everybody putting their foot down and standing up. What we should be doing is putting shows around and getting local music out as well. We also need the help of more people starting bands. We need a lot more aspiring artists and be able to get our city to keep running venues.

7. This in reference to the recent closure of 524 Studios, formerly an all-ages, diy music venue. This topic will be discussed in the next issue of Baton Rouge Alternative.

ceiling-to-floor headphones
a body all
headphones
all chatter
all, can you hear me now?

kaleidoscope books like
prominent dust
hand-rolled to
release the arm, to go
eat forgotten falafel

pile up undigested whims
you did not want to ask
me a question
you did not want to
scrub my fingers
shoulders toes with a biodegradable
sponge

I scrub:
to peel off skin
touched and untouched

Emily McCollister

New Local



"II" is Hyrda Plane's second full length album. Recorded, mixed and mastered by Earthship Records.

Buy it at hydraplane.bandcamp.com or at one of their shows.

Psychedelic Fusion
June 2018



"Watermelon" is Davy Goldsmith's first chapter book. It features 12 original poems and photos.

Buy it on www.lemonnight.net.

Abstract Poetry
July 2018



"Nothing, Nothing, Nothing" is a zine published by Emily Jean McCollister. It features the work of nine poets and artists.

Buy it at Tim's Garage, located at 4556 Government St.

Abstract art
June 2018

With George Lescano

Of Screaming Underwater

DG: I think that's the most lacking thing in the scene, places to play at. We've got a ton of awesome bands here.

GL: Yeah, we have a ton of bands but we don't have a place to play. It's horrible. Bands always want to play a house show. House shows are one of the most comfortable things. I think a lot of people though don't want to cater to certain bands especially to certain rowdy bands. When you bring certain rowdy bands, they mess up your venue. Even when we were having things at Bleachers[4], I don't think the people who owned it... wanted it.

DG: What was your favorite show you've ever played?

GL: I remember one of my favorite ones was playing Insomniacs[5] back in the day. It wasn't that crazy of a show but it was more comfortable as to where I was more related to where my bandmates were. We were all just hanging out, drinking, laughing, and partying and just played and afterwards we all just hung out again. That was when I was in Downtown Fiasco.

DG: What are some of your favorite bands you've played in?

GL: I did play in Thistle. It was one of my favorites because it was just a rowdy, folk-punk[6] band. We were able to just goof off, drink beers and just hang out and go ahead and shout words and stuff and it was awesome.

---

4. A recently closed bar that held consistent shows towards the end of it operation.
5. Formerly located on top of the abandoned Broadmoor Theatre, it was an all-ages venue in the 2000s.
6. Folk-punk is a sub-genre of punk, replacing more common instruments like electric guitar and bass with tradional Americana folk instruments like banjos, accordions, or washtub bass.

A Short History of Local Music

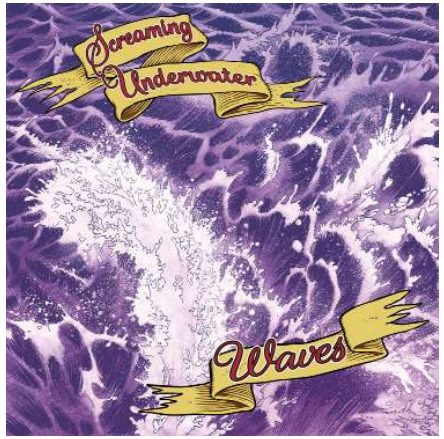
DG: When and where was your first show?

GL: We did one show at this garage and that was it. It was a bunch of our friends and we just hung out and did a show and that was it. I didn't know anything band-wise until later on. The reason I learned guitar was because I listened… to a band called Catch 22, the guy from Streetlight Manifesto. So when I did that I was listening to Ska[1] and I was just like, 'this is the greatest thing I've ever heard in my life. I want to play this.' Our first show was actually two shows in one night. We did one show over at [a] birthday party… and that night we also played with another band called "This Once Was a Beautiful City" and that was at our friend's garage. It was just a random garage. It was a bunch of kids, they were all the age of 14, 15, 16 like that just watching two bands try their best. They didn't even know what was going on and that was that. It was two house shows; that's what it was. Wait, no our first show was a venue. [The first show I went to was at] American Legion Hall[2]. American Legion Hall wasn't like the Darkroom[3], it was more do-it-yourself venue, kind of like what we're doing now. The Darkroom was more organized where [someone] owned it.

---

1. Ska is a genre of music originating from Jamaica in the 1950s and was influenced by Jamaican folk and American jazz (see The Wailers or The Skatalites). By the late 1970s Jamaican immigrants in the U.K. successfully blended the genre with punk sounds and attitude, forming 2 tone or ska revival (see The Specials or The Selecter). 3rd Wave Ska achieved commercial success in the 1990s with bands like Reel Big Fish and Less Than Jake.
2. A rentable entertainment hall.
3. The Darkroom was an active all-ages venue in the 2000s.

Releases



"Waves" is Screaming Underwater's first release. It is a four track demo recorded with Earthship Records; mixed and mastered by Bemo Barnett.

Buy it at one of their shows.

Surf Punk
July 2018



"Specular Fiction" is American Native's second full length album. Recorded, mixed, and mastered by Earthship Records.

Buy it at americannative.bandcamp.com or in person.

Alt/indie/pop rock
July 2018

New Local Releases Cont.

"What My Hair Says About You" is Laura Theobald's first full-length book of poetry, totalling 142 pages.

Pre-order it through Sad Spell Press at www.witchcraftmag.com/sadspellpress.

Lyrical Poetry
September 2018



"SWAMPASS" is a zine published by Kate Gauthreaux. It features the work of 25 poets and artists.

Buy it at Burger Mansion, August 17th.

Multi-genre
August 2018



SEAUXLA

Seaux LA was started in 2016 by co-founders Bruce Q. Williams & Keith Fort. We're based out of Baton Rouge, LA. Our friendship after years of shared interests in music from across Louisiana & the desire to make an impact in our community by bringing people together through multiple genres of music is our motivation. We curate multi-genre music compilations and lineups and promote local music. Seaux LA is also the executive producer of 2018's Bloom Music & Arts Fest on Oct. 6, in downtown Baton Rouge, LA.

facebook.com/seauxla



A weekly podcast that'll make you feel like you actually have friends. Your knowledge of the Baton Rouge scene will go up, but your IQ will go down.

…remember, when the content stops, the darkness starts to creep back in.

Listen on batonrougesucks.buzzsprout.com or on Spotify, iTunes, or Google Play.



Rougarou Pedals is a Louisiana based, handmade effect pedal company run by the husband and wife team of Nathan and Kara Heck and their good friend Ryan Church.

rougaroupedals.com

AN INTERVIEW

DG: What made you want to start Earthship Records?

BL: The biggest inspiration for starting a studio in general was an experience I had making a record in Philadelphia with Jeff Zeigler a few years ago. He basically converted his whole apartment into a studio and has made records for people like The War on Drugs and Kurt Vile there. The record we made there was with a band from Austin I play with called Boyfrndz under contract with Brutal Panda. It was my first experience getting flown out somewhere to make a record that was under contract and payed for by a record label. I started thinking about ways of combining the studio side of things with the record label side of things and that is sort of what Earthship Records was born out of. An Earthship is a mostly self-sustaining futuristic house that runs off of Energy from the sun, wind, and rainwater. The name "Earthship Records" comes from sort of using that as a metaphor for a single company with many resources that is capable of doing any part of the musical/artistic process, can produce different forms of art, and doesn't have many limitations. From writing/ arranging to producing to recording music to designing album art to putting out a finished product to making shirts to putting on shows etc. we love to do it all. My business partner, Justin, has also had a lifelong recording practice and gear addiction, so we work well together.

DG: What about Baton Rouge, in your opinion, needs to change about Baton Rouge to better suit your business?

BL: It is incredibly common to hear things like "Baton Rouge sucks" or "Baton Rouge needs this or that," but I rarely see the people who are constantly saying those types of things try to make any changes. Rather than worrying about what needs to change about Baton Rouge, I focus on what I can do to be better. It is super easy to say that Baton Rouge doesn't have a scene or that artists can't thrive in Baton Rouge, but I just don't believe that. I constantly see new artists, hear new

WITH MOOKIE DARDEN OF BURGER BOOKING

DG: At what point will you be content with the growth of Burger Booking? In other words, what are your overall goals?

MD: I'm really pretty happy with keeping Burger Booking a small operation while I try to navigate my own music career. I want to continue to host shows in my home for touring bands in need as often as possible. One day I would like to open a real venue in which Burger Booking can manifest itself into a physical form. A place where bands come from near and far, if not to play, just to say "hello" again. The best part of this whole booking adventure is meeting the rockers, the rappers, the fiddle rippers, and "Dusty in the back selling merch."

AN INTERVIEW

DG: What made you want to start Burger Booking?

MD: Like most independent musicians at the start of their careers, I relied on the kindness of small venues and promoters to supply shows for my various, unknown music projects. I now understand that there are "opportunity givers" in every music scene I have visited. These are the folks that have given independent bands, mine included, the opportunity to share music with people all over the country and the world. I wanted to help touring bands get in touch with venues and the right local support. I wanted to be an opportunity giver.

DG: What about Baton Rouge, in your opinion, needs to change about Baton Rouge to better suit Burger Booking?

MD: Well...I love Baton Rouge. It took me a while to realize how eclectic this city really is. When I moved to Nashville in 2013 I experienced an underground music scene like no other. House shows of all varieties were a nightly occurrence. I fell in love with being in crowded basements with people that looked, felt, believed, and perceived differently than myself. It was my introduction to the Nashville DIY scene that made me feel as though these communities should and could exist everywhere. I moved back to Baton Rouge in 2016 with the hope of being a part of the very real growth occurring here. What needs to change? I don't think the need for change is as important as the need to keep pushing forward...especially when we feel like the scene is getting knocked loose. However, as Gandhi said, "Be the change you wish to see in the world." This is so true for any blossoming music community. We need more participation here in Baton Rouge. We need people to offer up their homes to host shows, and those that attend need to offer up their respect for those homes and hosts. We need to buy each other's CDs and T Shirts. WE NEED TO TAKE INTEREST IN OUR PEERS.

artists, hear new bands, and meet new people who live here that are incredibly talented. I think that if I had to change one thing about Baton Rouge, it would be that everyone would take every second of energy spent on thinking something negative about Baton Rouge and, instead, spend those seconds creating something positive. Also, technology is also absolutely mind-blowing, and I can work with people from around the world from my studio. I think its appropriate to end with a Funkadelic quote: "Free your mind and your ass will follow."

DG: At what point will you be content with the growth of Earthship Records? In other words, what are your overall goals?

BL: Never. It is something I constantly want to be raising the bar for. If there is some sort of goal that I set for myself, achieving it isn't the final step. There's always work to be done and there are always going to be ways to get better. I think, overall, my goal is to follow where my instinct leads me and to continue to create things that I believe to be positive. There is a Buddhist concept called Dukkha, which basically means "fundamental dissatisfaction." I, by no means, claim to be a Buddhist, but I do like to read. "Fundamental dissatisfaction" refers to the painfulness and suffering of mundane life. This is something that most of us deal with every day; we wake up and think about our responsibilities, all the stuff we forgot to do yesterday, our backs hurt, and we are all slowly walking towards the grave. I think it is common to think that one day we will escape this dissatisfaction and reach some sort of peak.....like "ah, I've made it," but I am eternally grateful for my everlasting unsatisfactoriness, because it keeps me moving forward. My goal is to never stop and never be content.

